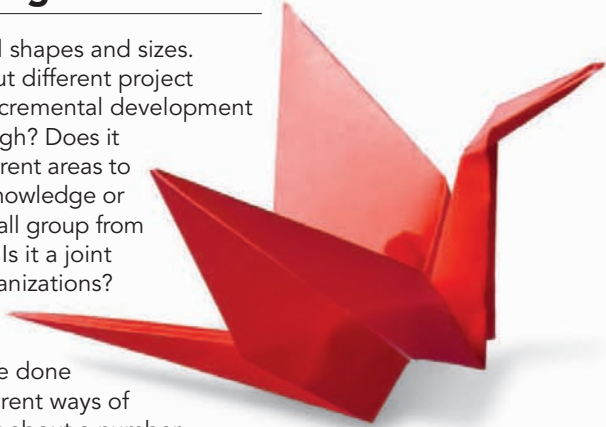


Choosing the right method

Innovations come in all shapes and sizes. You need to think about different project types—is it a simple incremental development or a radical breakthrough? Does it need people from different areas to cooperate and share knowledge or can it be done by a small group from the same department? Is it a joint venture with other organizations? Is it something completely different from anything you have done before and needs different ways of working? You can think about a number of options on a spectrum of project structures to help deal with each of these:

- **In-line structures:** carried out within the established group or by an individual as part of their work.
- **Matrix structures:** where people work some time on the project and the rest on their mainstream job.
- **Dedicated project team:** people work full time on the project and have dedicated resources.
- **Breakthrough or “skunk works” team:** the team operates independently of the main organization.



CASE STUDY

Making it relevant

The Ford Edsel was one of Ford's best-researched product concepts ever. Market analysis had led Ford to believe that a new luxury car priced in between its two nearest rivals would be an instant hit. The car was developed at great expense, hyped with aggressive marketing, and released with much fanfare in 1957,

but the final product failed. The Edsel was conceived during the economic growth of the early 1950s. By the time of its release in 1957, the US was on the brink of a recession, and consumers were turning to smaller, cheaper cars. The demands of the market altered. The Edsel remains a classic example of the dangers of not reviewing an innovation process.